

THE LAST WAR

WE FOUGHT

A Story of Survival During the Korean War



K I M R A O N

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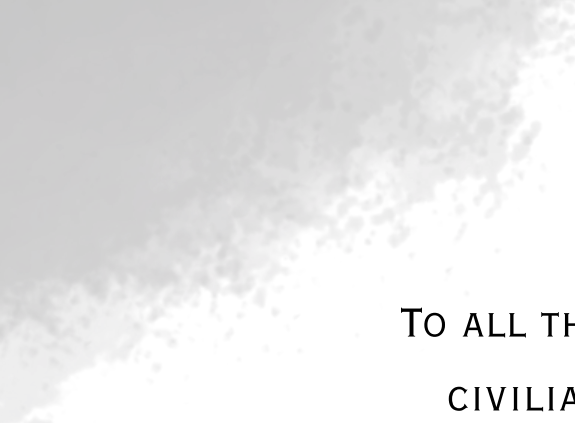
THE LAST WAR WE FOUGHT

A Story of Survival During the Korean War

**BY
KIM RAON**

This book combines historical facts with fictional storytelling.

Inspired by the events of the Korean War (1950-1953), this story honors the courage and sacrifice of those who lived through this difficult time in Korean history.



TO ALL THE SOLDIERS AND
CIVILIANS WHO LIVED
THROUGH THE KOREAN WAR.

TO MY FAMILY, WHO
SUPPORTS MY WRITING.
AND TO TEACHER PAULA, WHO
TAUGHT ME THAT I CAN WRITE
A WHOLE STORY.

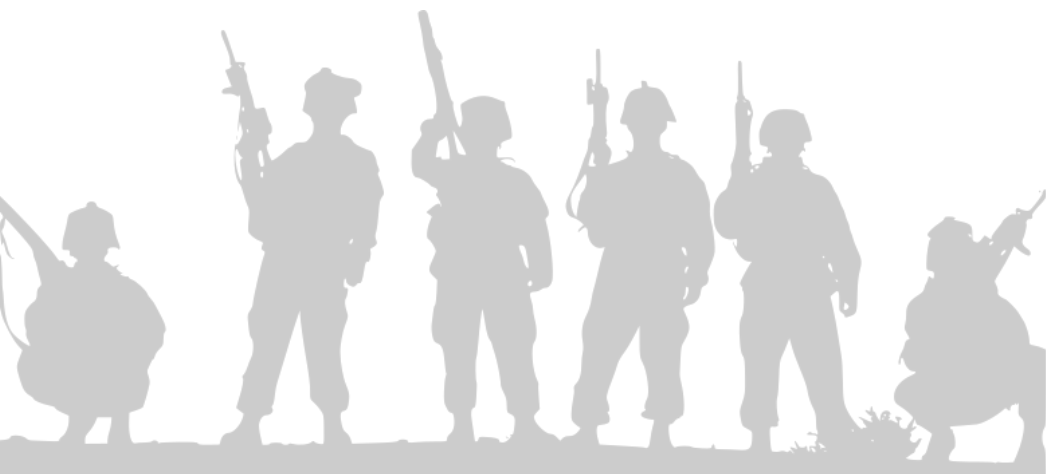
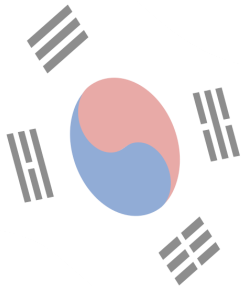


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INSPIRATION & HISTORY

The Korean War began on June 25, 1950, when North Korean forces crossed the 38th parallel into South Korea. For three years, the Korean Peninsula became a battlefield. Millions of lives were lost, families were separated, and cities were destroyed.

I wanted to write this story because even though history can feel far away, the people who lived through it were real. They felt fear, hope, anger, and love—just like we do today. Mincheol's story is fiction, but his experiences are inspired by the real struggles of Korean people during the war.

Some events in this book are historically accurate:

- The Incheon Landing led by General Douglas MacArthur
- The shortage of supplies and the fight for Busan
- The involvement of young, untrained soldiers
- The support North Korea received from other countries

Other parts come from my imagination—Mincheol's personal journey, his friendship with Minseok, and his survival.



The Invasion

CHAPTER ONE

Mincheol was exhausted. For six straight days, he and the other citizens had worked without rest. The city felt heavy with tiredness.

Then he heard it.

A low rumble at first, like distant thunder. But when Mincheol looked out his window, his heart stopped.

Soldiers. Hundreds of them. Invading. Before he could move, a bullet shattered the glass beside his face. Instinct took over. Mincheol ran.

He sprinted through the streets as people around him began to fall. A man reached out, crying, "Help me!" Mincheol wanted to stop. He wanted to help. But he couldn't. If he stopped, he would die too.

His eyes scanned desperately for anything useful—and found it. An oil can. A lighter. With shaking hands, he spilled the oil across the road behind him and threw the lighter.

Flames erupted, creating a wall of fire between him and the soldiers.

It wouldn't stop them forever, but it bought him time. He kept running. One thought repeated in his mind: Survive. Survive and find a way to fight back.

He ran until his legs gave out. Until his vision blurred. Until the world went dark. When Mincheol woke, he was in a strange village. Strangers hovered over him, their faces kind but worried. One pointed to his head, and Mincheol touched his face—then gasped.

His head was bleeding. A bullet must have grazed him while he ran.

The villagers gave him soup and let him rest. But Mincheol couldn't stay silent. "You have to leave," he warned them. "Soldiers are coming. They'll kill everyone."

An old man shook his head. "Our soldiers will protect us."

Mincheol wanted to believe that. But he had seen what was coming. He knew the truth: the enemy was closer than anyone realized.





The Firewall

CHAPTER TWO

That night, Mincheol prepared. He had another lighter from one citizen. His plan was desperate: when the soldiers arrived, he would burn the village houses to create another firewall. Then everyone could climb the trees and hide.

He persuaded some villagers to join him. Not all believed, but enough.

When the soldiers came, Mincheol lit the fire. Smoke filled the air as people scrambled up into the branches. But one villager fell, landing right in front of the enemy troops.

The soldiers grabbed him. "You!" their leader shouted, looking up at the trees. "You're the one who burned the city! You wounded our men!"

Mincheol's heart pounded. He couldn't fight them. He couldn't save the fallen villager. So he ran.

Again.

A knife flew past his head, missing by inches. Mincheol grabbed it from the ground as he fled. Now he had a weapon.

He ran through the forest for an hour, branches cutting his skin, his hair tangled and dirty. Finally, he reached the edge of the trees—and saw it.

An abandoned car.

He didn't know who it belonged to. He didn't care. Mincheol climbed in, prayed the engine would start, and drove.

Escape to Busan

CHAPTER THREE





Busan was chaotic.

Everyone had fled here. The city overflowed with refugees, and Mincheol had no money, no food, nowhere to sleep. He joined the crowds on the streets, starving but alive.

Weeks passed. Then enemy soldiers began moving closer to Busan.

Near the harbor, a ship was preparing to leave. It was carrying weapons and supplies meant for the South Korean and American forces. The ship was not meant for civilians.

Desperate citizens rushed to the dock. If they could board the ship, they might survive.

But the captain refused.

"These weapons are for the army," he said firmly. "They are more important than anything."

The crowd begged. They pleaded. Finally, someone's desperate words reached the captain's heart.

—

After a long silence, he made a painful decision. He would allow civilians to board but to make space, the weapons would have to be unloaded and left behind.

Mincheol watched as families climbed onto the ship. There were too many people. Some were left behind, crying on the dock.

When the enemy soldiers arrived, they found the abandoned weapons. Furious, they burned everything. Explosions lit up the harbor. At least the Americans couldn't use those weapons now.

But Mincheol wasn't on that ship. He had made a different choice.



KOREAN PENINSULA — 1950



The Incheon Landing

CHAPTER FOUR

The Americans knew they had to change the course of the war. General Douglas MacArthur developed a bold plan: invade Incheon and cut off the enemy's supply lines.

A direct attack would be suicide. The North Korean forces were too strong. So the Americans tricked them. They pretended to prepare for a landing somewhere else while secretly scouting Incheon.

Incheon was protected by high seawalls. The North Koreans believed no one would be foolish enough to attack there. But MacArthur saw something they didn't—there were two times each day when the tides made landing possible. Under cover of night, the American forces landed at Incheon. They succeeded. The supply lines were cut.

Soon, North Korean soldiers ran out of food and ammunition. South Korean territory from Incheon all the way to Busan was secured.

For the first time since the invasion, it seemed possible that the war might end. For the first time, there was hope.

A Brave Decision

CHAPTER FIVE





With the enemy weakened, South Korean and American forces pushed forward. Confused and starving, the North Korean soldiers couldn't fight as fiercely. This was the chance to end the war!

But then—Russia stepped in. Supplies began flowing to North Korea again. The advance slowed. The war would continue. Meanwhile, Mincheol had found something: a military truck with a message painted on its side.

"WE NEED AN ARMY. WE NEED SOLDIERS."
Soldiers were gathering recruits. Mincheol watched them for a long time.
Then he made his choice.



Training Days

CHAPTER SIX

Training was brutal.

The general shouted constantly. "If you can't reload in seven seconds, you run the track!"

Mincheol couldn't reload in seven seconds. None of the new recruits could. They ran. And ran. And ran.

His fingers swelled until they felt like sausages. Inside his head, Mincheol screamed. But the general gave no mercy.

"We'll do it three times more!"

Mincheol stared in disbelief. Three more times?

That's when he met Minseok. They stood side by side, exhausted and hurting.

"Why did you become a soldier?" Minseok asked.

Mincheol thought about the burning city, the falling bodies, the man who cried for help. "I want to finish this war," he said simply.







Two Friends

CHAPTER SEVEN

Minseok laughed. "One person? How can one person change a war?"

"I don't know," Mincheol admitted. "I just... want to."

"Okay, okay." Minseok's smile faded. "My family died. Because of soldiers. I won't let them survive."

For a moment, neither spoke. Then Minseok grinned again. "Well, you'd better learn to reload faster."

"You can't either!"

"WHAT?"

The Next Morning

The general gathered the trainees. "We're going to war."

Another officer protested, "They've only trained for five days!"

"We have no choice." The general turned to the young soldiers. "Can you do this?"

"YES!" they shouted together.

Mincheol's heart pounded as they marched toward the battlefield. This was really happening.

The Battlefield

CHAPTER EIGHT





The war continued for an hour. Gunfire never stopped. Soldiers fell on both sides.

Then Minseok's voice, panicked: "I'm out of bullets!"

Mincheol grabbed Minseok's empty gun and threw it like a spear. It struck a North Korean soldier in the stomach.

"Hey!" Minseok yelled. "Now I have NO weapon!"

"I'll protect you! Just get it back!"

Nearby, a young soldier shouted at an old man, "You have to run away! It's dangerous!"

The man blinked in confusion. Before the soldier could explain further, an enemy bullet found him. He fell, dead, having given his life trying to save a stranger.

The old man screamed in rage and grief. He grabbed a weapon and charged—but he didn't last long.

In the chaos, two young North Korean soldiers paused behind cover.

"How old are you?" one asked the other.

"Fifteen."

The first soldier shook his head. "Look behind you."

Minseok stood there. He raised his weapon and fired. Both boys fell.

Minseok stared at their bodies. They were his age. They were just kids.

He realized something he would never forget: war didn't only take South Koreans. It took everyone's children.

Loss

CHAPTER NINE



Mincheol survived.

Battle after battle, he kept going. But he was alone now. Tired. Stressed beyond anything he'd ever imagined.

Then Minseok died.

Mincheol saw it happen. One moment his friend was beside him. The next—

No.

No.

His hands shook. "Mi... Minseok? Minseok! Hey! Are you joking? Please tell me you're joking!"

But Minseok didn't answer.

Mincheol couldn't hold it in anymore. A scream tore from his throat, raw and broken.

But he must go ahead again and again.

Remembering

CHAPTER TEN





Now,

Mincheol is eighty years old. His hair is white, his hands are wrinkled, and his left eye never healed. Sometimes his grandchildren ask him about the war—about 6.25, as they call it.

For a long time, he couldn't speak about it. The memories hurt too much. Minseok's face. The burning city. The boy who was fifteen.

But his family wants to know. And Mincheol has realized something important:

This history—this terrible, painful history—is part of who they are. The people who fought and suffered and died deserve to be remembered.

Minseok deserves to be remembered.

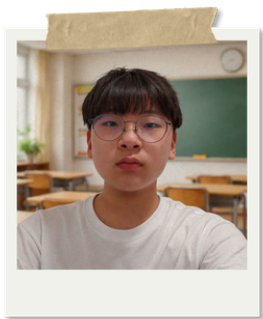
So Mincheol takes a deep breath. He pushes down the bad feelings, just a little.

And he tells them everything.

THE END

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About the Author



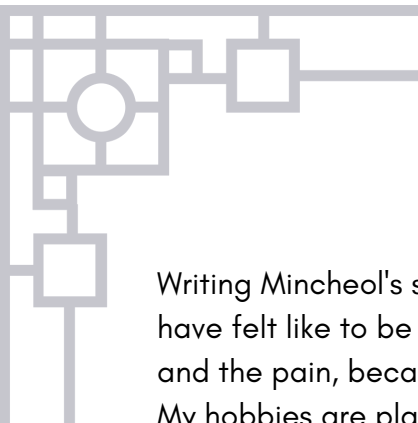
Hello! I am Kim Raon. I am 11 years old and will be entering 6th grade. I live in Seoul, Korea—the same city where my story begins.

I made this book in my Saturday class. To be honest, I don't usually like history that much. All those dates and names and battles can feel far away, like they don't matter anymore.

But I have always been interested in the 6.25 War (the Korean War). I think it's because I was impressed by the soldiers' sacrifices, even though they knew they might die. They fought for something bigger than themselves—for their families, for their country, for each other.

As I wrote this story, something changed inside me. I started to understand that war is not just action and explosions like in the movies I enjoy. It is also sad and serious. Real people lived through this. Real children lost their parents. Real soldiers cried for their friends.



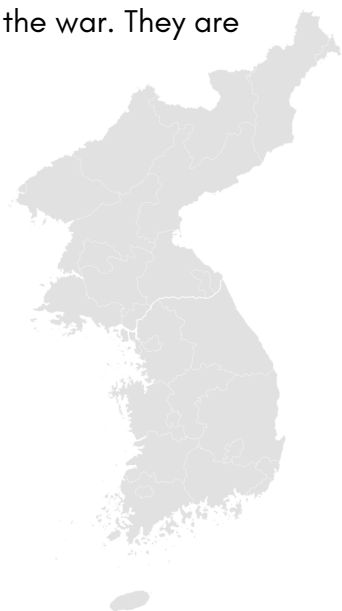


Writing Mincheol's story helped me imagine what it might have felt like to be there. I tried to show both the bravery and the pain, because I think that's the truth.

My hobbies are playing board games with my family and reading books—especially adventure stories. Maybe one day I will write another book.

Thank you, Teacher Paula, for believing I could write a whole story. My English is getting better because you never gave up on me.

Reading my book is your choice. I hope you like it—but more than that, I hope you remember Mincheol, Minseok, and all the people who lived through the war. They are the real reason this book exists.





Message from Teachers

For Raon,

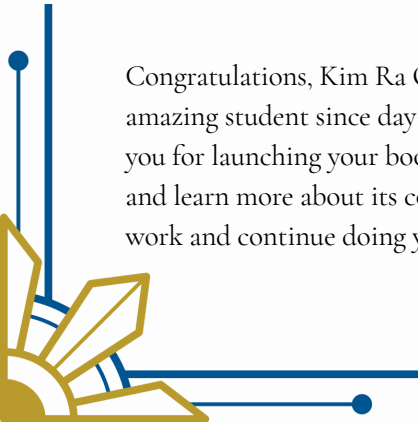
This story is more than just pages and words — it is your courage, your imagination, and your hard work brought to life. I am so proud of the dedication you showed in creating this book. May this be the first of many stories you will bravely share with the world.
Keep writing. Keep dreaming. Keep believing in yourself.

With pride and admiration,
Teacher Paula

Raon,

congratulations on publishing *The Last War We Fought!* At just 11 years old, you have shown courage not only in writing about war, but in sharing your thoughts and heart with others. Your story reminds us that history is not just about battles, but about people, feelings, and hope. Keep writing, keep imagining, and never forget—your voice truly matters.

- T. JM



Congratulations, Kim Ra On! You have been an amazing student since day one, and I am so proud of you for launching your book. I'm excited to read it and learn more about its content. Keep up the great work and continue doing your best!

-T. JC





Message from Teachers

Hi Ra On, this is Teacher Marc. First of all, I want to congratulate you—not just for this specific event, but for your growth as a child, a student, and as a person. You are such a sweet, loving, and kind student who knows how to have fun but still show respect to your teacher.

Thank you for being my student. I hope you will carry the learning with you—not just the academic lessons, but also the fun moments we shared in class. I am rooting for you and hoping that you will achieve everything you desire in life.

I will miss you. I hope we can see each other again, even if it's not in the academy—maybe in Korea? Haha! Have a safe flight!

To my student, Raon,

When you first started writing this story, you said, "Reading my book is your choice, and I will not care if you hate or like my story." But I hope you know that I truly admire what you've created.

Writing a complete story is not easy. You built characters, researched history, and imagined scenes of both action and emotion. You gave Mincheol a journey—from a scared citizen to a soldier carrying loss and memory. You showed that war is not just about battles, but about people.

Keep writing, Raon. Your voice matters.
— Teacher Noel



THE LAST WAR
WE FOUGHT

When war breaks out across the Korean Peninsula, three young soldiers find themselves facing fear, loss, and impossible choices. In the middle of the chaos of the Korean War, survival is not only about fighting on the battlefield — it is about holding on to hope, friendship, and humanity.

As bombs fall and families are torn apart, the soldiers must learn what it truly means to be brave. Through danger and uncertainty, they discover that courage is not just about strength, but about loyalty, sacrifice, and protecting the people they love.

The Last War We Fought is a powerful story of survival, brotherhood, and the enduring spirit of those who lived through one of history's most difficult times.

